AI ADVISOR & FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · SENIOR IT TRANSFORMATION LEADER

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PROFILE

IT transformation leader with more than thirty years of experience in the private and public sectors. Today I advise organizations on AI. As a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), I also build together with the client. I do this under my own brand, AI Advisory by Fender ICT.

My background is program management. I translate strategic objectives into a multi-year roadmap, a budget and a team that knows what to do. Working as an FDE asks for more. I know the rules for security and privacy, and I speak the language of the IT department. I work out the business case and involve right from the start the people who will eventually use the solution.

WHAT I BUILT WITH AI

2025 – present	**Personal AI operating system** · My own AI working environment, which I built and use every day.
Oct 2026 – present	**Customer portal and back office for Puur Reizen** · Brings customers, trips, documents and invoices together in one place for a travel agency.
Jul 2026	**Resource Capacity Planner** · One shared, live view of which teams are stretched and which are not.
Apr 2026	**Automated NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals evidence factory** · Compliance evidence for NIS-2 and the CCB's CyberFundamentals, collected automatically.

EXPERIENCE

Oct 2026 – present

AI Advisory by Fender ICT

Founder · AI Advisor & Forward Deployed Engineer

- AI advice: together with management, I look at where AI fits, where it does not and what it may do. I also check how it stays within the rules for security, privacy and audit.
- First client: Puur Reizen. Set up a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business together with the team, as a Forward Deployed Engineer. It has several projects and useful shared skills.

Mar 2021 – Sep 2026

Smals

Program Manager · Assistant IT Director

- Ran **three strategic programs at once**: public cloud, cybersecurity and emerging technologies, reporting to senior management through recurring steering committees.
- Turned regulation (NIS-2, CyberFundamentals, ISO 27001) and technical risk into priorities, budgets and roadmaps that management could decide on.
- Helped set up the **Public Cloud Center of Excellence** for the public social security institutions (OISZ) and co-wrote its strategic principles.

KEY FIGURES

33+ years in IT, since April 1993
20 employers and clients
16 certifications earned

EXPERTISE

Leadership and programs
Program and portfolio management · steering committees and reporting to C-level executives · budgets, CAPEX and OPEX · FinOps · suppliers and public tenders · teams of up to 25 people · interim IT management

Security and compliance
ISO 27001/27002 · ISAE 3402 · NIS-2 · CCB CyberFundamentals · NIST CSF · C2M2 · OWASP SAMM and ASVS · COBIT · GDPR · post-quantum cryptography

Cloud and infrastructure
Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · landing zones · Entra ID · VMware · Citrix · Red Hat OpenShift · Windows Server and Active Directory · SAN and NAS

AI and automation
AI agents and agentic workflows · Claude Code · Codex · Claude Team · ChatGPT Business · LLM pilots · context engineering · Python · automated compliance evidence

Methods
PRINCE2 · ITIL v3 · DEMO · Scrum · PMBOK · BPMN · Cloud Adoption Framework

Tools
Jira · Confluence · Sciforma · ServiceNow · CA Clarity · HP PPM · Power BI · M365

LANGUAGES

Dutch · Native

French · Bilingual

English · Full professional proficiency

STUDIES

Handelshogeschool Antwerpen
Candidate in Commercial Sciences (Kandidaat in de Handelswetenschappen) · 1993

École Commerciale de la Chambre de Commerce et d'Industrie de Paris (ECCIP)
Études Supérieures de Gestion, Cycle Supérieur de Gestion, option Finance et Contrôle de Gestion · 1992

Nov 2018 – Feb 2021

Burger Brands Belgium
Head of IT BeLux

- **€266K** saved in 2019 on an annual IT operating budget of €1.5M.
- **15%** higher franchisee satisfaction with IT, as measured in a survey.
- Organized the IT team of eight into three cells: operations, support and projects.

May 2018 – Oct 2018

Belfius
Project Manager Office 365

- Got the National Bank of Belgium, Microsoft and internal functions (legal, security, non-financial risk, compliance, data protection, contracts and audit) aligned.
- Guided the program through the internal and regulatory advisory process on outsourcing, including the materiality assessment, Cloud Risk Assessment and DPIA.

Nov 2015 – Apr 2018

Getronics BeLux
Project Manager Managed Services

- Migrated **more than 500 Argenta branches** and several partners to a new DMZ, together with other suppliers. Any failure meant branch downtime. Delivered on time, to specification and within budget.
- Led an end-to-end insourcing for Argenx: infrastructure (vBlock, Office 365, SIP trunk, MPLS) and managed services (service desk, field services, monitoring).
- **ISO 27001** and **ISAE 3402** (type I and II) certification for Getronics Belgium and Luxembourg, achieved **in ten months**.

Oct 2014 – Oct 2015

Deutsche Bank Belgium
Project Manager Application Services

- Led the release and environment management streams in Vittoria, the European Online Banking program of **over €15M**, built on ACI, Backbase and Alfresco. Also acted as product owner (Scrum).
- Steered several streams in the Essential Maintenance program (€4.4M), largely to remediate group audit findings.

Feb 2011 – Sep 2014

AXA Technology Services Belgium
Program Manager · Project Manager

- Led Nostradamus (RMPS2) for three years, a transformation program of **over 2,000 person-days** for AXA Group Solutions in France.
- Delivered a private cloud that became **the benchmark for all risk modelling applications** across the AXA group.
- Wrote the business case with three scenarios (private, hybrid and public cloud). This positioned AXA Tech in direct competition with Amazon AWS and Microsoft Azure, on price, service and expertise.

Leeds Polytechnic
Diploma in International Business · 1992

Université Catholique de l'Ouest, Centre International d'Études Françaises (CIDEF)
Diplôme de Langue et de Culture Françaises, niveau supérieur · 1988

Annuntia-Instituut
General secondary education, Modern Humanities, science track (Wetenschappelijke B) · 1987

RECENT TRAINING

AIS Live: Build Your AI OS (virtual event)
AI Automation Society, online · 2026

CISSP Cert Prep
ISC2 · 2024

Essentials in People Skills (online)
Vlerick Business School · 2021

CISM Online Review Course
ISACA · 2017

Data Protection Introduction (GDPR)
Data Protection Institute · 2017

ServiceNow System Administration
ServiceNow, Amsterdam · 2015

Expert Class Enterprise IT Architecture (DEMO)
Universiteit Antwerpen Management School · 2009

CERTIFICATIONS

Management and governance
ServiceNow Certified System Administrator (2015) · DEMO Professional (Design & Engineering Methodology for Organizations) (2009) · ITIL v3 Foundation (2009) · PRINCE2 Foundation (2008)

Infrastructure and virtualization
Microsoft Certified IT Professional (MCITP): Server Administrator (2009) · VMware Certified Professional (VCP) on VI3 (2009) · Microsoft Certified Technology Specialist (MCTS): Windows Vista, Configuration (2008) · Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA) for MetaFrame XP Presentation Server (2005) · Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA) (2005) · Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE): Windows Server 2003 (2004) · Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator (MCSA): Windows Server 2003 (2004) · Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA) for MetaFrame XP for Windows (2003) · Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE): Windows 2000 (2001) · Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) (1998)

Jan 2010 – Jan 2011

De Persgroep Publishing

Team Lead · Project Manager · Infrastructure Architect

- Led a team of **ten systems engineers** (Windows and Mac) and acted as interim IT Infrastructure Manager.
- Ran the insourcing program of **over 2,000 person-days** for the exit from Getronics, for Algemeen Dagblad, Trouw and de Volkskrant.
- **1,800 workstations** and the Windows back end replaced in four months, with a team of 25.

EARLIER CAREER · 1993 – 2009

Oct 2008 – Dec 2009	**Eandis** · Infrastructure Architect
Jan 2005 – Sep 2008	**Pioneer Europe** · Senior Systems Engineer
Sep 2004 – Dec 2004	**Agfa HealthCare** · Systems Engineer, Integration Engineering
Sep 2002 – Aug 2004	**Belgian Post Group** · Senior Systems Engineer
Mar 2001 – Aug 2002	**Merck Sharp & Dohme** · System Engineer, IS EMEA NT Computing
Dec 2000 – Feb 2001	**Telenet** · System Engineer
Nov 2000	**CGU Benelux** · System Engineer
Feb 2000 – Oct 2000	**Distrirest Benelux** · System Engineer
Jan 2000	**UUNET** · System Engineer
Mar 1998 – Dec 1999	**MSP bvba** · System Engineer
Mar 1996 – Feb 1998	**CW Lease Belgium** · NT System Administrator & AS/400 Operator
Aug 1995 – Nov 1995	**MFS Communications** · Data Analyst
Apr 1993 – Jul 1995	**Zuidnatie** · Novell System Administrator & Functional Analyst

Languages

Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires (1988) · Diplôme de Langue Française (1988)

All details, results and dates are in the full CV.